

91 Substitution

As well as ellipsis (leaving words out), repetition can be avoided by replacing some phrases with shorter ones. This is called substitution.

See also:

Countable and uncountable nouns 70

The past simple 7

91.1 SUBSTITUTING WITH "ONE / ONES" AND "SOME"

"One" and "ones" can be used to replace singular and plural countable nouns.

"Ones" can only be used to refer to a specific group of things. "Some" is used when the group is not defined, and to replace uncountable nouns.

SINGLE COUNTABLE NOUNS

Does anyone have a copy of the book?



Yes, I have **one**.

"One" replaces
"a copy of the book."

PLURAL COUNTABLE NOUNS

Are there any bookstores near here?



Yes, there are **some** on Main Street.

There are **a few great ones** across town.

"Ones" can only be used if
modified to define the specific
things that are meant.

FURTHER EXAMPLES

I got a raise at work, even though I didn't ask for **one**.



I knitted **some** scarves and sold **a few**.



"A few" can be used instead of "some."

Those new computers look great. I want **one** for my birthday.



I went shopping for dresses and found **some lovely ones**.



I need a new phone, but I don't know where would be the best place to buy **one**.



I saw there were new pastries at the bakery, so I thought I'd try **some**.

